

CONTENTS

1.	Why Resumes Fail + ATS	3
2.	Resume Architecture	5
3.	LinkedIn Optimization	8
4.	Cover Letters	10
5.	Portfolio = Proof	12
6.	Application System	14

Why This Guide Exists

Your resume is not a diary. It is a sales document. This guide teaches you to write one that gets responses — not rejections.

Every technique here is battle-tested. Every template is ready to customize. No fluff. No theory. Just what works.

CHAPTER 1

Why 75% of Resumes Never Reach a Human

ATS systems reject most resumes before a person sees them.

This You Type	What ATS Hears	Fix It
"Hard worker, team player"	No keywords -> rejected	"Led team of 4 to deliver X, reducing Y by 30%"
Wrong format (tables, headers, graphics)	ATS parser fails -> rejected	Simple formatting, no tables/graphics
Missing job description keywords	Low match score -> rejected	Mirror exact keywords from the posting
Generic file name "Resume.pdf"	Ignores file -> rejected	"YourName_Role_Company.pdf"

PLAY: ATS CHEAT

Copy the full job description into ChatGPT. Ask: "Extract the 15 most important keywords." Mirror them EXACTLY in your resume.

Resume Architecture

The structural formula that makes every bullet count.

Letter	Means	Example
S	Situation	2nd-year CS at XYZ U, no prior experience
T	Task	Build data analysis pipeline for real client
A	Action	Python ETL with pandas, ChatGPT for debug
R	Result	40% faster processing, client renewed contract
X	YOU	Sole dev. 3 days. Learned entire pipeline.

The 5-Second Test

Show your resume to someone for 5 seconds. Ask: "What do I do? What am I good at?" If they cannot answer, your headline needs work.

Action Verb Library

- ◆ **STRONG:** Built, Created, Led, Analyzed, Optimized, Designed, Delivered, Launched, Automated, Reduced, Increased
- ◆ **NEVER USE:** Helped, Worked on, Was responsible for, Assisted with, Participated in

LinkedIn Optimization

Recruiters Google you before they read your resume. Control what they find.

The Headline Formula

BAD: "Student at XYZ University"

GOOD: "Data Science Student | Python & ML | Building AI solutions"

GOOD: "Marketing Student | SEO & Content | Growing brand audiences"

Content Strategy for Students

- ◆ Post 2-3 times per week (consistency > perfection)
 - ◆ Share learnings: "This week I discovered X — here is what changed my mind"
 - ◆ Project walkthroughs: "How I built [thing] in [timeframe] using [tools]"
 - ◆ Career reflections: "3 things I wish I knew in my first year"
 - ◆ Engage meaningfully on 10 posts daily (comments > likes)
-

CHAPTER 4

Cover Letters That Work

The Hook-Story-Action framework that never sounds like a template.

Paragraph	Purpose	Formula
1. Hook	Grab attention	Specific insight about THEIR company. Not about you.
2. Story	Prove you are different	One concrete example with real numbers.
3. Action	Tell them what to do	"I would love to discuss X. Available [times]?"

[Hook: specific observation about their recent work/mission/news]

As someone who built [project with real numbers], I was immediately drawn to [company] because [specific reason].

In [context], I [action with measurable result].
[Second proof point with numbers].

I would welcome a conversation about how my experience with [specific skill] could contribute to [team/initiative].

PLAY: PROOF POINTS

Numbers everywhere: "Led team of 4" > "Led a team". "47% increase" > "improved". "3 days early" > "on time".

Portfolio = Proof

Projects speak louder than grades. Here is how to present yours.

The GitHub Profile Checklist

- ◆ Professional profile picture (or clean avatar)
- ◆ Bio: 2 lines max — who you are, what you build
- ◆ Pinned repos: 3-6 best projects with excellent READMEs
- ◆ Contribution graph: green dots every day (consistency beats intensity)

README Template

```
# [Project Name]

One-line description of what this does.

## What I Built
- Feature 1
- Feature 2

## What I Learned
- Skill/concept 1
- Skill/concept 2

## How to Run
```bash
pip install -r requirements.txt
python app.py
```
```


CHAPTER 6

The Application System

Track. Follow up. Customize. Win.

| Column | What to Track |
|----------------|--|
| Company & Role | Job title, posting link, date applied |
| Customization | What you changed in this application |
| Follow-up Date | 4-5 business days after applying |
| Status | Applied -> Screening -> Interview -> Offer -> Rejected |
| Notes | Screener name, interview dates, feedback |

The Follow-Up Formula

SUBJECT: [Role] application – following up

Hi [Name],

I applied for [Role] on [Date]. I am very interested because [specific reason tied to their work].

Would welcome a brief conversation if you are still reviewing applications. Thank you for your time.

Best,
[Your Name]

PLAY: QUALITY > QUANTITY

5 customized applications beat 50 generic ones. Tailor every resume. Write a unique cover letter. Follow up once.

YOUR NEXT INTERVIEW IS COMING.

The right resume. The right LinkedIn. The right application. Now you have all three.
